

SIMATS ENGINEERING
ASSESSMENT TOOL 1: Analytical Problem Solving

COURSE NAME:

Cloud Computing and
Big Data Analytics

COURSE CODE:

CSA15 A1

COURSE OUTCOME COVERED

CO2: Analyze virtualization architectures to identify performance and security issues in cloud computing environments. (BL3)

Dave's Taxonomy: Manipulation (Level 2)
Question Count: 5

Total Marks: 50

Code of Conduct

I 192365046 (Name / Reg No) certify that this submission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specified for this assessment.

I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will result in disciplinary action.

Signature of the student: [Signature]

Assessment Tasks

Analytical Problem Solving

1. Compare Type-1 and Type-2 hypervisors for a cloud datacenter hosting mission-critical applications. Analyze performance, security, and manageability, then justify the better choice.
2. A cloud provider must isolate workloads belonging to finance, healthcare, and student portals on the same hardware. Analyze how virtualization architecture supports isolation and identify two major attack surfaces.
3. Study the following VM host utilization snapshot and recommend corrective actions: CPU 92%, memory 88%, storage I/O latency 35 ms, average VM boot time 170 s. Explain the likely bottlenecks.
4. Analyze how Software Defined Datacenter architecture improves agility compared with a traditional datacenter. Support your answer with compute, storage, and network virtualization considerations.
5. A multi-cloud federation project fails due to identity mismatches between providers. Analyze the issue and propose a secure identity and privacy design using federation concepts.

① Compare Type-1 and Type-2 Hypervisor for a cloud datacenter hosting mission-critical Applications

Introduction

A hypervisor is virtualization software that enables multiple virtual machines (VMs) to run on a single physical server

Feature	Type-1 Hypervisor	Type-2 Hypervisor
Installation	Run directly on hardware	Run on top of a host operating system
Performance	Very high	Moderate due to OS overhead.
Security	Strong isolation and smaller attack	Lower security because host OS can be compromised
Resource usage	Efficient utilization	Additional resource consumption.

Analysis:

Performance

- Type-1 provides near-native performance
- Type-2 experience additional latency because every request passes through the host OS.

Security:

- Type 1 - has better isolation and fewer vulnerabilities.
- Type 2 - is vulnerable if the host operating system is attacked.

Manageability:

- Type-1 supports clustering snapshots, high availability and centralized monitoring.
- Type-2 is mainly used for development and testing.

Justification:

For mission-critical cloud application, Type-1 Hypervisor is the best choice because it provides:

- High performance
- Better security
- High availability
- Efficient resource utilization
- Enterprise scalability.

Conclusion:

Hypervisors are preferred for production cloud datacenters because they ensure reliability, security and maximum performance. and the preferred production are enterprise data centers and high availability, efficient resource utilization.

② Workload Isolation Using Virtualization Architecture

Introduction

virtualization enables multiple organizations to share the same physical hardware while keeping workloads isolated.

How Virtualization Supports Isolation

- Separate virtual machines for each department
- Hypervisor isolates CPU, memory and storage resources
- Virtual networks prevent unauthorized communication.
- Virtual firewalls enforce security policies.
- Storage virtualization separates data volumes
- Access control restricts administrative privileges

Isolation Example

- Finance - VM1
- Healthcare - VM2
- Student portal - VM3

Each VM has:

- Independent operating system
- separate memory.
- Dedicated storage

Major Attack surfaces

1. Hypervisor Attacks

- Hypervisor escape
- VM breakout
- privilege escalation

2. Virtual Network Attacks:

- VM sniffing
- VLAN hopping
- ARP spoofing
- Unauthorized lateral movement

Recommendations

- Use secure Type-1 hypervisors.
- Enable encryption for storage and network traffic.

Apply role-based access control

- Regularly update hypervisor patches

Conclusion:

Virtualization architecture provides strong workload isolation while reducing hardware costs, but hypervisor and virtual network security must be carefully protected.

3 VM Host Utilization Analysis.

Given Snapshot

- CPU Utilization = 98%
- Memory Utilization = 88%
- Storage I/O latency = 35 ms
- Average VM Boot Time = 170 sec

Analysis

CPU Bottleneck

- CPU usage is extremely high
- VMs compete for processing resources
- Results in slower application response.

Corrective Action.

- Add more CPU cores
- Migrate VMs to another host
- Enable CPU load balancing

Memory Bottleneck

- Memory utilization is close to maximum.
- Hypervisor may start swapping memory.

Corrective Action

- Increase RAM
- Optimize VM memory allocation
- Remove unused VMs

Storage Bottleneck

- Storage latency of 35 ms is high
- slow disk access delays VM operations.

Corrective Action

- upgrade to SSD/NVMe storage
- Use storage caching
- Improve storage RAID configuration

VM Boot Time

- 170 seconds is much higher than expected
- Mainly caused by storage and CPU bottlenecks

Corrective Action

- optimize startup sequence
- Use fast storage
- Reduce unnecessary startup service.

Conclusion

The host is overloaded upgrading CPU, RAM and storage along with balancing workloads will improve overall VM performance. Resource contention among VMs.

4 Software defined Data centers (SDDC) vs Traditional Datacenters.

Introduction

A software defined datacenter (SDDC) virtualizes compute, storage, and networking resource allowing centralized software-based management.

Feature	Traditional Datacenters	Software defined data center
compute	physical servers	Virtual machines
Storage	Dedicated storage devices	Storage virtualization
Network	Hardware switches	Software-defined network
Management	Manual	Automated
Scalability	slow	Rapid
Resource provisioning	Manual	on-demand

How SDDC Improves Agility

1. Compute virtualization

- Dynamic VM creation
- Live migration
- Auto scaling

2. Storage virtualization

- Storage pooling
- Thin provisioning
- Snapshot and replication

Benefits:

- Faster deployment
- Better resource utilization
- Reduced operational cost
- Automated management
- High availability
- Disaster recovery support

Conclusion

SDDC significantly improves agility by automating compute, storage and network management making it more flexible and efficient than traditional datacenters.

⑤ Multi-cloud Federation Identity Problem.

Problem Analysis:

In a multi cloud environment different cloud providers use different identity systems.

This leads to:

- Multiple user accounts
- Authentication failures
- Inconsistent permissions
- Difficult user management.
- Increased security risks.

Secure Identity and Privacy Design

1. Identity Federation

- Use a centralized Identity provider (IdP)
- All cloud providers trust the same identity source.

2. Single sign-on (SSO)

- Users authenticate once
- Access multiple cloud services secure

3. Standard Authentication protocols

- SAML
- OAuth 2.0
- OpenID connect

4. Multi factor Authentication (MFA)

- Password + OTP or biometric verification

5. Role-Based Access control (RBAC)

- Assign permissions based on user roles
- Enforce least privilege.

Benefits.

- Centralized identity management
- Improved security
- Better privacy
- Simplified administration
- Seamless multi-cloud access.

Conclusion:

Implementing Identity federation with SSO MFA RBAC standard authentication protocols ensure and efficient access across multiple cloud providers while protecting user privacy.